

AUDITION CHECKLIST

Six Characters in Search of an Author

Sei personaggi in cerca d'autore

Luigi Pirandello · trans. Edward Storer (1922)

Village Players · Lausanne

DIRECTOR'S WORKING PAGES

HOW TO USE THESE PAGES

One page per role, plus an auditioner-info form at the front and a general assessment page at the back. Tick the boxes during the audition. Write the auditioner's name and date at the top of each role page so the pages don't get mixed up across the morning.

Each role's checklist is divided into **Reading** (does the actor understand who this is?), **Signature & arc** (did they handle the specific moves the production scores?), and **Voice & body** (the technical performance).

The final box on each page — *Yes / Maybe / No* — is your snap impression. Use the lined notes area for anything more specific.

Auditioner

IDENTITY

Full name _____

Date of audition _____

Phone _____ Email _____

LANGUAGES

English _____ French _____

Other _____ Native _____

ROLES AUDITIONING FOR

Primary _____

Open to _____

AVAILABILITY

June 2026 (auditions / line reads) _____

August–November 2026 (weekly rehearsals) _____

Late autumn 2026 (performance run) _____

Known conflicts _____

PRACTICAL

Headshot/résumé received _____

Available for callbacks _____

Auditioner _____ Date _____

The Father

the brain of the family

A well-educated middle-class man whose intellectual elegance is his shield against shame. The philosophy is autobiographical, disguised as metaphysics. Fighting for his existence, not lecturing.

READING

- ☐ Plays him as a man fighting for his existence, not lecturing
- ☐ Intellectual elegance reads as shield against shame
- ☐ The philosophy lands as autobiographical, not abstract
- ☐ Mellifluous when controlling the rhythm; violent when it breaks
- ☐ Believes every paradox in real time

SIGNATURE & ARC

- ☐ The handkerchief appears at moments of greatest shame
- ☐ Handkerchief out at *hundred francs*
- ☐ Handkerchief gripped at *proof that I am a man*
- ☐ Four-stage arc visible: control → injury → attack → horror
- ☐ *Can you tell me who you are?* — turns out to the house
- ☐ *Because I suffer, sir* — the cry breaks through philosophy
- ☐ *Our reality cannot change* — closing stillness is paralysis, not composure

VOICE & BODY

- ☐ Voice carries the long speeches without strain
- ☐ Listens to the Step-Daughter as she cuts him
- ☐ Does not anticipate the Step-Daughter's attacks
- ☐ Comfortable with stillness
- ☐ Comfortable with the Step-Daughter's proximity inside the intimacy protocol

NOTES

VERDICT

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____ Date _____

The Mother

silence that finally screams

Silence is her language. The body does her acting — hands, veil, the bundle, the chair-and-coat. The keystone line *It's taking place now* must land like a stone learning to speak.

READING

- ☐ Heavy under the veil — the veil does her listening for her
- ☐ Not crushed in the sentimental way; pressed down for so long it has lost the muscle for its own posture
- ☐ Three silences distinguishable (Act 1 / Act 2 / Act 3)
- ☐ Holds both children at once in Act 3 — the bundle and the chair-and-coat

SIGNATURE & ARC

- ☐ Hands score the part: grip tightens at *illusion*, at *reality*, at *he always knew exactly where to find me*
- ☐ The veil — lifted once by the Father against her will; lifted once on her own at the fountain
- ☐ Eyes mostly on the floor
- ☐ *It's taking place now. It happens all the time* — lands like a stone learning to speak
- ☐ *My son! My son!* — the voice has been waiting an entire production to use itself

VOICE & BODY

- ☐ Available for long stillness without restlessness
- ☐ Cry (the eruption at Madame Pace, the cry at the fountain) carries without being pushed
- ☐ Body is specific, not generic
- ☐ Does not perform sympathy

NOTES

VERDICT

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Date _____

the one who refuses to let it be made beautiful

- ☐ Sharp, in control, never apologetic, never coquettish
- ☐ The wit is real; the wit is rage
- ☐ Refuses to let the Father become the hero of the scene
- ☐ Tenderness for the Child (bundle) is unbearably real
- ☐ Contempt for the Boy (chair-and-coat) reads as the same wound, pointed the other way

- ☐ Three cuts against the Father, each colder than the philosophy:
- ☐ 1. His **reality**. He always knew exactly where to find me.
- ☐ 2. He was real that afternoon. With his hundred francs. He was very real.
- ☐ 3. His doesn't change. Mine doesn't either. He should know.
- ☐ Worse? Listen. — early exposure lands cold, not theatrical
- ☐ I am dying to live that scene — disgust and revenge in the same beat
- ☐ Cry out, mother. Cry out as you did then. — physical contact is choreographed and bounded

- ☐ Voice level, never raised in the cuts
- ☐ Holds the bundle as if its stillness depends on her
- ☐ Available for the intimacy protocol (knows it, has read it)
- ☐ Comfortable refusing to soften her own line

VERDICT

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

The Son

the one who will not act

The production's most modern figure. The adult child who has been told to show up for a parent's narrative and has decided no. Hands in pockets. Eyes on the floor. The mirror speech surprises him.

READING

- ☐ Quiet, cold, with the energy of someone who would leave if he could
- ☐ Every line is a door closing
- ☐ Agrees with the author who abandoned them — *Exactly what it was, sir; exactly that*
- ☐ Refusal is aesthetic and ethical, not stubbornness
- ☐ Becomes more himself the more he is held in place

SIGNATURE & ARC

- ☐ Hands in his pockets the entire part
- ☐ Never looks at the chair-and-coat or the bundle
- ☐ Looks at the floor, the wall, the wings — not at the Manager unless he has to
- ☐ The one moment of looking up: *Exactly what it was, sir. Exactly that.*
- ☐ *Delighted! Delighted!* — tries to leave
- ☐ *I act nothing* — the body finally still, a kind of dignity arrives
- ☐ Mirror speech: surprises him on the word *horrible*, not before
- ☐ Fountain narration: breaks out of him because he cannot keep it inside any longer

VOICE & BODY

- ☐ Stillness reads as presence, not passivity
- ☐ Voice carries the mirror speech without melodrama
- ☐ Fountain narration delivered in broken beats
- ☐ Available for being physically restrained by the Father

NOTES

VERDICT

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Date _____

the symbol of the audience itself

The Manager is the audience, concretely. Everything he does is what the audience does in their seats. The clipboard is their program. His verbal tics are their thoughts. He delivers, in the closing line, what they were going to say themselves.

- ☐ Plays him as the audience itself, not a director-on-deadline cliché
- ☐ Cynicism is technique; compassion is real
- ☐ Almost understands what he is watching; never quite admits it
- ☐ Not a buffoon

- ☐ The clipboard signature — under the arm, on the table, in the hand
- ☐ Clipboard goes down on *By Jove, it tempts me*
- ☐ Picks it back up when the action becomes unbearable
- ☐ Audience-like verbal tics: *I don't understand at all / Let's hear them out / Damned good / Effect certain*
- ☐ The pivot: stands, picks up the chair-and-coat himself, walks it to the fountain
- ☐ The closing line played straight — no commentary, no irony
- ☐ Walks off the stage the way a man leaves a theatre

- ☐ Practical, working-director voice — not theatrical
- ☐ Sits at the table forward, slightly bored, half-engaged — the audience's posture
- ☐ Almost says *Pirandello* in Act 3 Part II and stops himself
- ☐ Available for the long Act 3 stretch without losing energy

NOTES

VERDICT

☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____ Date _____

Player 1

one character in five hats — the faded Leading Man

A once-promising Anglo actor who came to Lausanne thinking it was a stepping stone to Paris. Paris did not happen. Vanity is now a defense mechanism. He plays five roles but always as himself.

READING

- ☐ Plays five roles, but always as himself
- ☐ Anglo English (he thinks of it as classical; audience reads as English)
- ☐ Vanity is defence; affection underneath
- ☐ He does not know he is funny

SIGNATURE & ARC

- ☐ The comb signature — small, in the breast pocket
- ☐ Comb out at *I have a reputation in this canton*
- ☐ Comb out as the Door-keeper (out of habit)
- ☐ Comb out at *By me, if you've no objection*
- ☐ Comb pressed to chest like a small cross when Madame Pace materialises
- ☐ *Neither am I. I am through with this scene* — two steps toward exit, calculation crosses face, he stops
- ☐ Plays the Father in the shop scene with practised gallantry

VOICE & BODY

- ☐ Carries five distinct hats without losing the spine
- ☐ Comfortable with comic exposure
- ☐ Pretentious in his Stanislavski-talk without naming Stanislavski
- ☐ Available for the shop-scene playing within the intimacy protocol

NOTES

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☐ Yes

☐ Maybe

☐ No

Auditioner _____

Date _____

Player 2

the diva and the props

The veteran character actress who actually is what Player 1 pretends to be. Has done leads at every Lausanne house. Knows the audience by name. Also does the props because the budget is small.

READING

- ☐ Senior actor in the company — does not need to say so
- ☐ Diva is real, earned, tired
- ☐ Property Man is the same woman with the chain raised
- ☐ Both registers, one body

SIGNATURE & ARC

- ☐ Reading glasses on a long silver chain
- ☐ Glasses down to inspect a prop, read a cue, give an appraising look
- ☐ Glasses up when she is being looked at
- ☐ *I insist on being treated with respect — and reasonable lighting — otherwise I go*
- ☐ The wound: the Step-Daughter laughs at her attempt to play the Step-Daughter
- ☐ *I have been made a fool of — believe me — by considerably better — the glasses come off*
- ☐ Act 3: would like to be at home with the cat

VOICE & BODY

- ☐ Comfortable flipping between Leading Lady and Property Man inside a single scene
- ☐ Wounded pride lands without histrionics
- ☐ Available for the shop-scene playing within the intimacy protocol
- ☐ Practical, no-nonsense Property Man bearing

NOTES

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☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

Auditioner _____ Date _____

Player 3

the youngest, and Madame Pace

The earnest one. Carries the Juvenile Lead, the Prompter, and the production's most theatrically demanding moment — Madame Pace, who arrives comic and exits chilling.

READING

- ☐ Earnest, genuinely curious about the Characters
- ☐ Juvenile Lead — the most theatrically open of the three Players
- ☐ Prompter — meticulous, slightly older, in the box
- ☐ Madame Pace — comic on arrival, chilling on exit

SIGNATURE & ARC

- ☐ Player 3 transformation is the production's most demanding moment
- ☐ *Buongiorno, buongiorno, signor* — comic entry, full theatricality
- ☐ *He clean. He polite. He pay cash* — the bookkeeping of shame
- ☐ Smile never drops; only what she is saying changes
- ☐ *Sì sì, certo. I go. I go.* — exit not furious, unhurried
- ☐ *Don't you forget the name. La Pace.* — parting threat

VOICE & BODY

- ☐ Half-Italian, half-French dialect carried without losing meaning
- ☐ Audience must laugh on her first line, regret laughing by her last
- ☐ Available for the wig, the heels, the powder — full physical transformation
- ☐ Available for the touching protocol with the Step-Daughter (hand under chin, briefly)

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☐ Maybe

☐ No

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Overall impression

After the role-specific pages — a summary of voice, body, working temperament, and the bigger questions.

VOICE

- ☐ Clear projection
- ☐ Range and colour
- ☐ Available for verse rhythms / broken-beat work
- ☐ English diction
- ☐ French diction / accent comfort
- ☐ Listens with the voice

BODY

- ☐ Stage presence
- ☐ Listens with the body
- ☐ Comfortable with stillness
- ☐ Comfortable with the chair-and-coat / bundle conventions
- ☐ Available for intimacy protocol

WORKING TOGETHER

- ☐ Takes direction
- ☐ Generous in scene
- ☐ Asks specific questions
- ☐ Available for full rehearsal arc

BIGGER QUESTIONS

- ☐ Can hold the Characters' register (timeless, serious, ghost-like)
- ☐ Can hold the Players' register (local, modern, amateur in the best sense)
- ☐ Has read the intimacy protocol
- ☐ Has read the Light & Sound score
- ☐ Brings something we did not know we needed

DIRECTOR'S FINAL IMPRESSION

OVERALL

- ☐ Yes ☐ Maybe — call back ☐ No ☐ Open for another role